WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Report Rules

Document Rules 01 | Issue 4 | Owner: Street Care Office | Review cycle: every twelve months

1. Purpose

These rules say how a defect report and the records of past reports are read: how each of the three channels writes each answer and what it is read as, which revision of a report is the report, how each requirement of a defect standard is judged Met, Not met or Not documented, and how the documents attached to a report are read against it.

They hold no requirement of their own. Every requirement and its figures are written in the defect standard of the report's own defect type, and the worked example of section 13 uses figures that belong to no defect type.

2. The three channels

Reports come through the council website's report form, through the StreetCare app on a phone, and from telephone calls that the contact centre types up. Each channel writes the same report its own way. An answer is read the same whichever channel wrote it, and a spelling these rules do not list is refused, naming it, never guessed.

The records of past reports and the repair logs keep each report as its channel wrote it, and the answers added later - the review outcome, the repeat cause, the repair method, the traffic management and the completion code - are written in the same channel's way. So are the column height, which comes from the council's lighting inventory, and the planned crew hours, which come from its standard times.

The street is one of the council's named streets and the district one of its four inspection districts, each written by its name in every channel, and so is the reporter type - Resident, Business, Councillor, Bus operator or School. The location description is the reporter's own words. The permits live beside a report are counted from the street works register; the report gives everything else.

3. References

Every report takes its number from the council's system. The website writes SC and seven digits, as in SC0050118; the StreetCare app writes SC- and the number, as in SC-50118; and the contact centre writes the bare number, 50118 for the same report. Each is read as SC and the number in seven digits, so all three are SC0050118.

Street works permits are written SWP and seven digits, documents DOC- and six digits, and statement sentences SEN- and seven digits, the same in every channel.

4. Depths and widths

The depth or vertical step of a defect, its width and the depth of standing water are read as whole millimetres. The website writes the number alone, as in 45 for 45 millimetres; the StreetCare app writes centimetres, as in 4.5 cm; and the contact centre writes the caller's inches, as in 1.75 in.

Centimetres are multiplied by 10 exactly and inches by 25.4 exactly, and the result is rounded half up once to whole millimetres: 4.5 cm is 45 mm and 3.95 cm is 40 mm; 1.75 in is 44 mm, 0.8 in is 20 mm, 1.25 in is 32 mm and 2.25 in is 57 mm.

5. Heights and distances

How far standing water reaches from the kerb, the clear height under vegetation and the height of a lighting column are read as metres to one decimal: the website writes the number alone, as in 1.2 for 1.2 metres; the StreetCare app writes 1.2 m; and the contact centre writes feet, as in 4 ft.

A length in feet is multiplied by 0.3048 exactly and rounded half up once to one decimal: 4 ft is 1.2 m, 3.4 ft is 1.0 m, 7.9 ft is 2.4 m, 16.4 ft is 5.0 m and 26 ft is 7.9 m.

6. Leans and hours

The lean of a column is read as degrees from upright to one decimal: the website writes the number alone, as in 6.5 for 6.5 degrees, and the StreetCare app writes 6.5 deg; a caller cannot measure a lean, and the contact centre leaves it blank.

The planned and actual crew hours are read as hours to one decimal: the website writes the number alone, as in 2.5 for 2.5 hours; the StreetCare app writes minutes, as in 150 min, divided by 60 and rounded half up once to one decimal, so 45 min is 0.8 hours; and the contact centre writes 2.5 hrs, or 1 hr for a single hour.

7. Counts

The number of previous reports at a location, a revision number, the street works permits live on a street and how many of them conflict, the size of a crew and the number of documents attached are whole numbers, written the same way in every channel.

8. Named answers

The defect type is written in full on the website - Carriageway, Footway, Drainage, Vegetation or Street lighting - as a description in the StreetCare app - Pothole or road surface, Pavement defect, Flooding or blocked drain, Overhanging tree or hedge or Street light fault - and as a code by the contact centre - CW, FW, DR, VG or SL. Each is read as the defect type in full. The linked defect type is written the same way, and no linked defect is written No linked defect, None or NIL.

The street category is Traffic sensitive or Local road on the website, Main route or Residential street in the StreetCare app, and TS or LR by the contact centre.

Where water stands, and where vegetation overhangs, is Carriageway or Footway on the website, Road or Pavement in the StreetCare app, and ROAD or PATH by the contact centre.

The lighting fault is Lamp out, Day burning or Leaning column on the website; Light not working, Light on in daytime or Column leaning in the StreetCare app; and OUT, DAY or LEAN by the contact centre.

Yes is written Yes on the website, true in the StreetCare app and Y by the contact centre, and no is No, false and N; yes, y, true and 1 are also read as Yes, and no, n, false and 0 as No.

The records of past reports add the answers given after the decision. The review outcome is Repaired as reported, Repaired after inspection, Repaired after coordination or Closed after inspection on the website; Repaired, Repaired - inspected, Repaired - coordinated or Closed - inspected in the StreetCare app; and REP, REP-INS, REP-CRD or CLS-INS by the contact centre. The repeat cause is Repair failed, Defect returned nearby, Regrowth, Blocked again, Lamp failed again or Worsened after inspection on the website; Repair failed, New defect nearby, Grown back, Blocked again, Failed again or Got worse in the StreetCare app; and FAILED, NEARBY, REGROWTH, REBLOCKED, REFAIL or WORSE by the contact centre.

A repair log's repair method is Patch repair, Permanent reinstatement, Slab relay, Gully cleanse, Drain repair, Cut back, Lamp replacement, Photocell replacement or Column replacement on the website; Patch, Permanent, Relay slabs, Cleanse gully, Repair drain, Cut back, Replace lamp, Replace photocell or Replace column in the StreetCare app; and PATCH, PERM, RELAY, GULLY, DRAIN, CUT, LAMP, PECU or COLUMN by the contact centre.

Its traffic management is None, Signs only, Lane closure or Road closure on the website; No traffic management, Signs, Lane closed or Road closed in the StreetCare app; and NONE, SIGNS, LANE or CLOSED by the contact centre, and its completion code is Completed, Completed with overrun or Completed after return visit on the website; Done, Done - overran or Done - second visit in the StreetCare app; and COMP, COMP-OVR or COMP-RTN by the contact centre.

The street care office's labels on past statement sentences are written several ways, each read as one of the nine sentence types: Measurement as "MEASUREMENT", "Measurements" or "measurement"; Location as "LOCATION", "Where" or "location"; Photograph as "PHOTOGRAPH", "Photo" or "photograph"; Hazard as "HAZARD", "Danger" or "hazard"; Incident as "INCIDENT", "Accident" or "incident"; Traffic and use as "Traffic & use", "Traffic" or "traffic-and-use"; Previous reports as "PREVIOUS REPORTS", "Previous report" or "previous-reports"; Weather and water as "Weather & water", "Weather" or "weather-and-water"; Background as "Context", "General" or "background". Each type is also read when written as its own name.

A document's type is Resident description, Call note, Photo note or Inspection note. In the street works register a permit's status is Live or Cancelled, its works location Carriageway or Footway, and its works promoter Water company, Gas network, Electricity network, Telecoms or Council contractor.

Every named answer is read whatever its capitals and with any spaces around it trimmed, and so are the street, the district and the reporter type.

9. Missing answers and impossible readings

An answer left blank is written N/A or not known on the website, left empty or written null in the StreetCare app, and written - or caller unsure by the contact centre; NA is also read as blank, and each of these, an empty answer among them, is read as blank whichever channel it comes from. A question the report does not ask is written N/A on the website, left empty in the StreetCare app and written - by the contact centre, and is blank too.

An impossible reading is made blank, never corrected: a depth, a width or standing water of nought or less, a reach, a clear height or a column height of nought or less, a lean below nought or above 90 degrees, planned or actual crew hours of nought or less, a negative count of previous reports, and a crew of nobody.

A record of a past report whose reported again answer is blank, or a repair log whose actual crew hours are blank or impossible, cannot be learned from and is left out of the records. So is a past statement sentence of fewer than three words, or one whose type is blank.

10. Revisions and repeats

A report sent again before its review, with an answer added or put right, comes with a higher revision number. The highest revision is the report, whatever an earlier revision said and wherever the rows sit in the file; the earlier revisions are never screened. A report sent again after a decision takes the next revision number in the same way. A row repeated exactly is one row, in the live files and in the records alike.

11. Requirement results

Each requirement of the defect type's own standard, and of its linked type's, is Met, Not met or Not documented:

- A yes-or-no requirement is Met on Yes, Not met on No and Not documented when the answer is blank.
- A requirement written at least is met at its figure, and one written at least and at most is met at either of its figures. A requirement written less than is not met at its figure: a clear height of exactly the figure leaves the street clear. Every reading is compared in the unit its standard states, converted where it was written in another, and rounded half up once to the precision these rules read it at - whole millimetres, and a tenth of a metre, of a degree and of an hour - whether it was converted or not. Every figure is compared as an exact decimal.
- The water reach is a follow-on question decided by where the water stands: Met on the footway; on the carriageway Met at or beyond the standard's figure, Not met short of it and Not documented when the reach is blank; and Not documented, asking for the water location alone, when the water location is blank.
- The clear height is decided by where the vegetation overhangs: over a footway it is held to the standard's footway figure and over a carriageway to its carriageway figure; Not documented, asking for the overhang location alone, when that is blank; and Not documented when the clear height is blank.
- The column lean is decided by the fault: Met for a lamp that is out or burns in daylight; for a leaning column Met at or beyond the standard's figure, Not met short of it and Not documented when the lean is blank; and Not documented, asking for the fault alone, when the fault is blank.

A requirement that is Not documented names the answers it needs that were left blank, and only those. A report with a linked defect type is screened under its own standard first and then under its linked type's, and each requirement keeps the standard it came from. Then the assessment follows, as the Highways Policy sets out: any requirement Not met or Not documented makes it INSPECT ON SITE; otherwise any coordination trigger makes it REFER FOR COORDINATION; otherwise it is ORDER REPAIR.

12. Statements against the report

Every document is read as plain words: markup tags are taken out, character entities are read as the characters they stand for and no-break spaces as spaces, and every run of spaces and line breaks is read as one space. It is then split into its sentences in order: a sentence ends at a full stop, a question mark or an exclamation mark followed by a space. Each sentence is given one of nine types: measurement, location, photograph, hazard, incident, traffic and use, previous reports, weather and water, or background. Each type bears on the requirements its statement guide names; hazard, incident, traffic and use, previous reports and background bear on none.

A sentence typed as a measurement is searched for figures, each written in one of four forms, in any capitals: a number followed by mm deep, a number followed by mm wide, a number followed by mm of standing water, or a number followed by m clear, with one space between each part. Each figure is compared as it is written, without rounding, as an exact decimal, with the report's own reading of the same answer: the depth, the width, the water

depth or the clear height. Only measurement sentences are searched, and a sentence of any other type is never flagged.

A sentence with no such figure is not flagged. One with a figure is flagged DESCRIBES BLANK ANSWER where the report's reading of that answer is blank - left blank, or not asked of its defect types - and otherwise DISAGREES WITH FORM when any of its figures differs from the report's. Against a report 45 millimetres deep, "The hole is 45 mm deep at its deepest point." is not flagged; against a report 38 millimetres deep, it disagrees with the form. A flag never changes an answer: the report is what the reporter gave, and the disagreement is for the Highways Inspector to settle.

13. A worked example

This example uses a standard that belongs to no defect type, made up so that every reading is seen at work at once, outside any real standard: a depth of at least 30 millimetres, a width of at least 100 and at most 1000 millimetres, standing water at least 40 millimetres deep, and, where the water stands on the carriageway, a reach of at least 1.5 metres from the kerb.

A report comes from the contact centre, written CW and linked DR, on a street written TS. Its depth, written 1.25 in, is 1.25 times 25.4, or 31.75, which rounds half up once to 32 mm, at least 30: Met. Its width, written 3.9 in, is 99.06, which rounds to 99 mm, under 100: Not met. Its standing water, written 1.5 in, is 38.1, which rounds to 38 mm, under 40: Not met. The water stands on the road, written ROAD, and its reach is written caller unsure, which is blank: Not documented, asking for the reach and only the reach.

That is Met 1, Not met 2 and Not documented 1, so the assessment is INSPECT ON SITE. The street is traffic sensitive, so the traffic-sensitive street trigger applies too - but the requirements come first.